

New Lord of the Rings Movie Is Still on Its Way

From: Polygon Mined: 2026-10-05 5 min read

Fans of The Lord of the Rings can relax. A new movie co-created by TV host Stephen Colbert is still being developed, despite rumors this weekend that it had been put on hold, Polygon reports.

On October 4, a website called Knight Edge Media reported that the project was "paused" because two big entertainment companies, Paramount and Warner Bros., have merged. But the report did not name a specific source. On October 5, Rob Keyes of the website Screen Rant called the report "inaccurate." He wrote that the movie's status was "exactly as it was weeks ago," with writers still working and no budget or filming date confirmed yet. Warner Bros. also contacted Knight Edge Media to say the movie is "not 'canceled' and is still **in development**."

The film, **tentatively** called The Lord of the Rings: Shadows of the Past, was announced in March 2026 by Peter Jackson, who directed the original Lord of the Rings movies. Colbert, a famous fan of author J.R.R. Tolkien, is working on it with his son, **screenwriter** Peter McGee, and with Philippa Boyens, who helped write the earlier films.

The story will take place 14 years after Frodo has passed on. His hobbit friends Sam, Merry and Pippin set out to retrace the first steps of their old adventure. Meanwhile, Sam's daughter, Elanor, discovers a long-buried secret about the War of the Ring. The movie will draw on early chapters of the first book that were left out of the original films.

Fans will not have to wait for it to visit **Middle-earth** again. Another movie, The Hunt for Gollum, directed by Andy Serkis, is set to reach theaters on December 17, 2027.

Word Treasure

merger -- When two companies join to become one.

in development -- Still being planned and written, not yet filmed.

tentatively -- For now, and could still change.

screenwriter -- A person who writes the script for a movie.

Middle-earth -- The made-up world where The Lord of the Rings takes place.

Break it down

Lead: the movie is still in development

The rumor and the response from Screen Rant and Warner Bros.

Who is making the movie

What the story will be about

Another Lord of the Rings movie coming in 2027

Why it matters

It shows how a rumor can spread online and why checking sources and official statements matters.

Test what you remember

1. Which website first reported the movie was "paused"?

- ☐ (A) Knight Edge Media
- ☐ (B) NPR
- ☐ (C) Variety
- ☐ (D) Polygon

2. Why did that report say the movie was paused?

- ☐ (A) Because of bad weather
- ☐ (B) Because Paramount and Warner Bros. merged
- ☐ (C) Because Colbert retired
- ☐ (D) Because filming ended

3. Who called the report "inaccurate"?

- ☐ (A) Rob Keyes of Screen Rant
- ☐ (B) Philippa Boyens
- ☐ (C) Peter Jackson
- ☐ (D) Andy Serkis

4. Who is working on the movie with Colbert?

- ☐ (A) Daniel Radcliffe
- ☐ (B) David Attenborough
- ☐ (C) Tom Cruise
- ☐ (D) His son Peter McGee and Philippa Boyens

5. Who discovers a long-buried secret in the story?

- ☐ (A) Frodo
- ☐ (B) Merry's brother
- ☐ (C) Gollum
- ☐ (D) Sam's daughter, Elanor

6. Who is directing The Hunt for Gollum?

- ☐ (A) Peter McGee
- ☐ (B) Andy Serkis
- ☐ (C) Stephen Colbert
- ☐ (D) Rob Keyes

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: B 3: A 4: D 5: D 6: B

Questions to think about

1. **Knight Edge Media:** Reported the project was paused, without naming a specific source.
2. **Warner Bros.:** Said the movie is not canceled and is still in development.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):